

Daniel Short

daniel@danielshort.me | Grand Junction, CO | 469-600-2297 | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#) | [Website](#)

APPLIED DATA SCIENTIST | NLP, ML & DEPLOYMENT TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Modeling** - Python, PyTorch, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Classification, Anomaly Detection
- **NLP & LLMs** - Embeddings, FAISS, Semantic Search, RAG, LoRA Fine-Tuning, Transformers
- **Deployment** - Docker, AWS Lambda, SageMaker, APIs, Model Serving, Inference Pipelines
- **Evaluation** - Feature Engineering, Experiment Design, Prompt Evaluation, Data Cleaning, Error Analysis

WORK EXPERIENCE

Business Analyst
Visit Grand Junction

February 2024 – Present
Grand Junction, CO

- Built reusable domain corpora for citation-based chatbot and semantic-search prototypes over destination content.
- Analyzed AI search, GEO, and organic discovery patterns to guide LLM-readable content and measurement workflows.
- Launched 66 surveys and screeners to more than 1 million consumers, turning response data into market and content strategy inputs.
- Automated recurring analytics outputs so content and reporting data could be reused in retrieval, evaluation, and downstream experimentation.

AI Data Quality Analyst
Randall Reilly

November 2023 – January 2024
Remote

- Re-platformed R workflows into a one-click Python app, cutting delivery time by 95%.
- Built decision-tree models that expanded serial-number tracking by over 10x while flagging anomalies with 98% precision.
- Deployed an autoencoder model that lifted overall data quality for downstream analytics.

Asset Protection Data Analyst
Target

June 2022 – November 2023
Montrose, CO

- Designed dashboards that boosted theft reporting by 57.6% and increased prevention 180%.
- Reduced inventory loss by 24% through analytics-driven investigations and tooling.
- Presented actionable insights to non-technical stakeholders across multiple teams.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **M.S. Data Science**, Eastern University - GPA: 4.0/4.0 May 2025
- **B.S. Data Analytics**, Purdue University Global - GPA: 3.6/4.0 May 2023

[IBM Data Analyst](#), [IBM Machine Learning](#), [Google Analytics](#), [Google Data Analytics](#), [Google Advanced Data Analytics](#)

PROJECTS

- [Smart Sentence Retriever](#) - Built embeddings-based semantic search with AWS Lambda ranking.
- [Chatbot \(LoRA + RAG\)](#) - Fine-tuned a Mistral chatbot with retrieval and cited answers over destination content.
- [Handwriting Legibility Scoring](#) - Fine-tuned a PyTorch CNN and built a custom legibility evaluation set.
- [Sheet Music Watermark Removal & Upscale](#) - Built a UNet + VDSR pipeline to clean and upscale sheet music images.